

AC9M3ST01 • Year 3 Mathematics

Collecting and Recording Data

Data collection should answer a clear question. Categorical data uses labels, while discrete numerical data uses countable numbers.

We are learning to...

acquire data for categorical and discrete numerical variables to address a question of interest or purpose by observing, collecting and accessing data sets; record the data using appropriate methods including frequency tables and spreadsheets

Ask question

Identify variable

Collect fairly

Tally

Frequency table

Check total

Success criteria

- I can ask data questions.
- I can identify variable types.
- I can collect data.

Key vocabulary

categorical data

discrete numerical data

frequency table

Record responses in a frequency table

Transport	Tally	Frequency
Walk		4
Bus		6
Car		3

Each response is recorded once and the frequencies match the tallies.

Distinguish variable types

favourite fruit = categorical

number of siblings = discrete numerical

both can answer survey questions

Choose a recording method that suits the variable and purpose.

Show what you know

Give a categorical variable.

Think silently, show your reasoning, then explain it to a partner.

Expected response

Favourite fruit is categorical data because responses are names, not counts.

If students are unsure

State exactly what data will answer.

categorical data

discrete numerical data

frequency table